Best Practices for Biomedical Research Data Management

Module 6: Biomedical Ethics
IRB: Institutional Review Board

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This video will provide an overview of Institutional Review Boards and best practices for human subject research. It will be a review of the basic principles and connection to IRB approval requirements.

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IRB Essentials

What is the IRB?

The Institutional Review Board is the committee that reviews, approves, and monitors research on human subjects.

Why do IRBs exist?

- Mandated through federal regulations
  - Department of Health and Human Services
  - Food and Drug Administration

Why do IRBs exist?

- Response to such abuses as the Tuskegee Syphilis Study (1932 to 1972)
  - Began as 6-to-8 month study of the natural history of untreated syphilis
  - Subjects recruited without informed consent
  - Misinformed about the research procedures (e.g., spinal taps as “special free treatment”)
  - Treatment with penicillin withheld

Dunn, C. M. G., & Chadwick, G. L. (2002). *Protecting study volunteers in research: A manual for investigative sites*. Boston, Mass: Thomson CenterWatch. http://www.cdc.gov/tuskegee/timeline.htm

Why do we need IRB review?

- No one can be objective about their own work
- People underestimate the risks involved in things they are very familiar with
- People overestimate the benefit of things that are important to them

OHRP slides, “Doing it right…together,”
Downloaded 2/19/14 from http://irb.duhs.duke.edu/
as “Top Ten Investigator Responsibilities”

Three basic principles govern human subjects research.

Principle	Requirements for IRB Approval
Respect for Persons (autonomy): • Let people make their own choices • Provide additional protections to people with diminished autonomy	
Beneficence: • Maximize possible benefits and minimize possible harms	
Justice: • Treat people fairly • *Who ought to receive the benefits of research and bear its burdens?*	

Adapted from Amdur, R. J. (2007) Principles of the Belmont Report. In R. J. Amdur & E. A. Bankert (Eds.), *Institutional Review Board Member Handbook* (pp. 21-29). Boston, MA: Jones & Bartlett Publishers

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Justice: • Treat people fairly • *Who ought to receive the benefits of research and bear its burdens?*	• Vulnerable subjects not targeted for convenience • People likely to benefit not systematically excluded

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Research means a systematic investigation, including research development, testing and evaluation, designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge.

(45 CFR 46, subpart A, section 46.102)

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<u>Human subject</u> means a living individual about whom an investigator conducting research obtains: (1) Data through intervention or interaction with the individual, or
(2) Identifiable private information.

(45 CFR 46, subpart A, section 46.102)

Ask yourself, for your activity:

1. Will you interact or intervene with people to gather information about them?
2. Will you access, collect, use, etc. private identifiable information?
3. Will you be conducting a systematic investigation designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge?

YES to 1 or 2 <u>plus</u> YES to 3
means your activity is human subjects research

All projects that qualify as research and involve human subjects must have prior IRB review and approval.